Six ways to get common fields, compared at scale

What each method gives you, what it costs to maintain, and whether it runs on the lake.

● ◑ ○ Fields: full to none ● ◔ ○ Upkeep: heavy to none

METHOD	FIELDS YOU GET	UPKEEP AT HUNDREDS OF SOURCES	RUNS ON THE LAKE	USE IT FOR
Per-source DCR into ASim or custom tables Ingest time	● Full ASIM fields	● One DCR per source	✓ Yes, check table tier support	Top 10 to 20 sources by volume
ASIM parsers at query time Query time	● Full ASIM fields	◔ Microsoft maintains	⊗ No	Analytics-tier tables only
ASIM parser logic inlined in KQL jobs or notebooks Query time	● Full ASIM, where a parser exists	◔ Scheduled sync from the Azure-Sentinel GitHub repo	✓ Yes	Sources Microsoft already parses
Discovery scan and entity index Scheduled job	◑ IP, user, host, hash, URL	◔ One synonym dictionary	✓ Yes	The long tail of tables
Syslog template mining Scheduled job	◕ Fields per message template	◑ Review new templates	✓ Yes	Unix syslog, auditd, raw text
Free-text search Query time	◔ Literal indicator matches	○ None	✓ Yes, slow; test union * first	Backstop for indicators

ROUTE EACH SOURCE TO A METHOD

Source has an ASIM parser	Inline the ASIM parser logic	Tier 1
Structured fields, no parser	Discovery scan and entity index	Tier 2
Raw text: syslog, auditd	Template mining, then value regex	Tier 2
Any source, any time	Free-text search as a backstop	Tier 3

Mix for hundreds of sources: inlined ASIM logic, the entity index, template mining and free-text search.

Keep per-source DCRs for the few highest-volume sources. Writing and maintaining hundreds of them does not scale.

Sources: Microsoft Learn, ASIM and data lake KQL documentation; LevelBlue analysis

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